Moonsun (Sunny) Jeon

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EDUCATION

Michigan State University *East Lansing, MI*
Ph.D., Department of Communication *Aug. 2022 – Present*

- Dissertation (Expected May 2027): *Message Processing Under Ego-Defensive Attitude: Examining the Visual Attention and Retention Effects*
- Committee: Dr. Maria Lapinski (Advisor), Dr. Monique Turner, Dr. Ralf Schmälzle, Dr. Joseph Cesario

The University of Georgia *Athens, GA*
M.A., Department of Communication Studies *Aug. 2020 – May 2022*

- Interpersonal and Health Communication (GPA: 3.95/4.00)
- Thesis: *The Role of Identity and Bandwagon Cues in Graphic Health Warning Messages on Social Media: An Eye-Tracking Approach*
- Committee: Dr. Jiaying Liu (Advisor), Dr. Chelsea Ratcliff, Dr. Mackensie Minniear

Sungkyunkwan University (SKKU) *Seoul, Korea*
B.A., Double Major *Mar. 2015 – Aug. 2019*

- English Language and Literature (GPA: 4.19/4.50) & Media and Communication (GPA: 4.23/4.50)

AREAS OF RESEARCH

Health Communication; Persuasion and Social Influence; AI-Mediated Communication and Misinformation; Strategic Communication and Audience-Targeted Messaging; Message Processing (Eye Tracking, Virtual Reality)

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

** denotes equal contribution*

10. Cho, H. J.*, **Jeon, M.***, & Turner, M. M. (in print). The use of effective persuasive strategies in obesity prevention campaigns: A content analysis. *Health Promotion Practice*. https://doi.org/10.1177/15248399261493467

9. Lim, S., Cho, H. J.*, **Jeon, M.***, Cui, X., & Schmälzle, R. (in print). Immersive media messages that catch the eye: Examining factors that elicit attention and replicating the link between attention and memory. *Journal of Media Psychology*.

8. **Jeon, M.**, Lim, S., Lapinski, M. K., Bente, G., Spates, S. A., & Schmälzle, R. (2026). Visual attention and retention effects of a design element in culturally targeted messages: Introducing the virtual billboard paradigm. *Communication Quarterly, 74*(2), 165–195. https://doi.org/10.1080/01463373.2026.2629568

7. **Jeon, M.**, & Kim, Y. (2026). The role of fear, hope, message fatigue, and message shocking value in promoting the public's understanding and support toward COVID-19 wastewater monitoring. *JMIR Formative Research, 10*, e83060. https://doi.org/10.2196/83060

6. Rasul, M. E., Oh, Y. J., **Jeon, M.**, Cho, H. J., & Calabrese, C. (2026). When distrust shapes news choice: Perceptions of mis- and disinformation and news consumption across traditional and social media outlets. *Cyberpsychology, Behavior, and Social Networking, 29*(3), 151–158. https://doi.org/10.1177/21522715261424695

5. Oh, Y. J., **Jeon, M.**, Cho, H. J., & Rasul, M. E. (2026). Narcissism predicts misinformation engagement through information seeking: Evidence from a representative survey. *Acta Psychologica, 262*, 106155. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.actpsy.2025.106155

4. Liu, J.*, Mi, R. Z.*, **Jeon, M.**, Fabbricatore, J., Wicke, R., Cojulun, L., & Yang, S. (2025). Visual attention and memory retention of cannabis warning labels: An eye-tracking experiment with young adults. *Annals of Behavioral Medicine, 59*(1), 1–8. https://doi.org/10.1093/abm/kaaf094

3. Rasul, M. E., Calabrese, C., Oh, Y. J., Cho, H. J., **Jeon, M.**, & Boukes, M. (2025). "It's all fake news!": How perceptions of misinformation and disinformation influence news consumption across traditional media, social media, and AI. *Journalism & Mass Communication Quarterly, 102*(4), 993–1019. https://doi.org/10.1177/10776990251373085

2. Lapinski, M. K., Kerr, J. M., Miller III, H. W., **Jeon, M.**, & Tracey, K. (2024). Persuasive communication, financial incentives, and social norms: Interactions and effects on behaviors. *Current Opinion in Psychology, 59*, 101851. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.copsyc.2024.101851

1. **Jeon, M.**, Kim, Y., & Bouslavskaya, T. (2024). Do body positive images improve our body perception? The role of social comparison on body perception and moods. *Asian Communication Research, 21*(3), 385–403. https://doi.org/10.20879/acr.2024.21.023

MANUSCRIPTS UNDER REVIEW

Jeon, M., & Liu, J. (revise & resubmit). The role of similarity and consensus cues in graphic health warning messages on social media: An eye-tracking approach. *Health Communication*.

Zhu, X., Kim, Y., & **Jeon, M.** (revise & resubmit). When do health discussion networks backfire: The role of message fatigue and risk perceptions. *Journal of Health Psychology*.

Wang, Y., Lapinski, M. K., **Jeon, M.**, Dawadi, A., & Lucas, T. (revise & resubmit). Do conspiracy beliefs moderate the effects of culturally targeted messages on behavior? A randomized controlled trial. *Health Communication*.

Calabrese, C., Rasul, M. E., Cho, H. J., **Jeon, M.**, Kim, T., & Oh, Y. J. (revise & resubmit). Development and validation of a deepfake literacy scale: Predictors and correlates of deepfake literacy. *Behaviour & Information Technology*.

Turner, M. M., Cho, H. J., Jang, Y., **Jeon, M.**, Lim, J. I., Tran, P., & Wade, R. (revise & resubmit). Rage and reason: A large-scale scoping review of experimental effects of anger on judgments, cognitive processing, and persuasive outcomes. *Annals of the International Communication Association*.

Jeon, M., Oh, Y. J., & Zhang, X. (under review). Who is responsible when AI fails? Mind perception, moral evaluation, and distributed responsibility in AI-assisted decisions. *Behaviour & Information Technology*.

Kim, Y., **Jeon, M.**, Park, H. J., & McCullom, M. (under review). Memorable messages received by young adult cancer survivors: A thematic co-occurrence analysis of message content and impact. *Health Communication*.

Oh, Y. J., **Jeon, M.**, Cho, H. J., Calabrese, C., & Rasul, M. E. (under review). Public perceptions of AI deepfake harm: Personal, societal, and third-person perception shaped by AI trust, AI risk perception, and demographics. *The Social Science Journal*.

Zhang, X., Oh, Y. J., & **Jeon, M.** (under review). Rethinking AI dependency: Functional and existential forms in relation to identity threat and anxiety. *Health Communication*.

Oh, Y. J., Zhang, X., **Jeon, M.**, Bergholz, T. M., & Yi, J. (under review). Promoting safe food handling practices through norm-based artificial intelligence chatbots. *Journal of Nutrition Education and Behavior*.

Zhang, X., Oh, Y. J., & **Jeon, M.** (under review). When AI edits the self: Psychological tradeoffs in adopting AI-generated headshots. *Journal of Internet Commerce*.

MANUSCRIPTS IN PREPARATION

Jeon, M., Molina, M. D., Lapinski, M. K., & Rogel, G. (in preparation). When cultural targeting goes wrong: The roles of perceived identity relevance, stereotype, and manipulative intent in responses to Hispanic-targeted health messages. Target journal: *Journal of Health Communication*.

Jeon, M., Lapinski, M. K., & Park, S. (in preparation). Scientific consensus meets social norms: How consensus messaging and norm appeals jointly shape attitudes toward GMO foods and meat reduction. Target journal: *Science Communication*.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

25. **Jeon, M.**, Zhang, X., & Oh, Y. J. (2026, November). AI as a tool vs. a colleague: How user openness and AI mind perception shape responsibility attribution for AI errors [Extended abstract]. National Communication Association (NCA) 112th Annual Convention, New Orleans, LA.

24. **Jeon, M.**, & Lapinski, M. K. (2026, November). The role of social identity in ego-defensive processing from in-group or out-group message source [Extended abstract]. NCA 112th Annual Convention, New Orleans, LA.

23. Yoon, H., Turner, M. M., Cho, H. J., & **Jeon, M.** (2026, November). Not all efficacy is the same: Disaggregating self-efficacy, response efficacy, and retributive efficacy in anger-based persuasion [Extended abstract]. NCA 112th Annual Convention, New Orleans, LA.

22. Turner, M. M., Cho, H. J., Du, Y., Lim, J., **Jeon, M.**, & Yoon, H. (2026, November). Measuring emotional flow: Assessing self-report and psychophysiological indicators with multi-trait multi-measure methodology. NCA 112th Annual Convention, New Orleans, LA. **Top Paper, Communication and Social Cognition Division**
21. Zhang, X., Oh, Y. J., & **Jeon, M.** (2026, November). When AI edits the self: Psychological tradeoffs in adopting AI-generated headshots. NCA 112th Annual Convention, New Orleans, LA.
20. Calabrese, C., Rasul, M. E., Cho, H. J., **Jeon, M.**, Kim, T., & Oh, Y. J. (2026, November). Development and validation of a deepfake literacy scale: Predictors and correlates of deepfake literacy beyond general AI knowledge. NCA 112th Annual Convention, New Orleans, LA.
19. Oh, Y. J., **Jeon, M.**, Cho, H. J., Calabrese, C., & Rasul, M. E. (2026, November). Public perceptions of AI deepfake harm: Personal, societal, and third-person perception shaped by AI trust, AI risk perception, and demographics. NCA 112th Annual Convention, New Orleans, LA.
18. Turner, M. M., Cho, H. J., & **Jeon, M.** (2026, June). Message design matters: Assessing persuasive strategies in obesity prevention campaigns. International Communication Association (ICA) 76th Annual Conference, Cape Town, South Africa.
17. Zhu, X., Kim, Y., & **Jeon, M.** (2025, November). When do health discussion networks backfire: The role of message fatigue and risk perceptions. NCA 111th Annual Convention, Denver, CO.
16. **Jeon, M.**, Lapinski, M. K., Wang, Y., Lucas, T., & Dawadi, A. (2025, November). The moderating role of racial identity in culturally-targeted health messaging: Predicting SARS-CoV-2 serology testing among Black Americans [Extended abstract]. NCA 111th Annual Convention, Denver, CO.
15. Turner, M. M., Yoon, H., **Jeon, M.**, Cho, H. J., & Lim, J. I. (2025, November). Crossing the efficacy threshold: When anger turns counterproductive. NCA 111th Annual Convention, Denver, CO.
14. Turner, M. M., Cho, H. J., Yoon, H., **Jeon, M.**, & Du, Y. (2025, November). The anger defiance hypothesis: When discouraging efficacy fuels agency. NCA 111th Annual Convention, Denver, CO.
13. Turner, M. M., Yoon, H., **Jeon, M.**, Cho, H. J., & Lim, J. I. (2025, June). How low can you go? Testing the efficacy threshold for the anger activism model. ICA 75th Annual Conference, Denver, CO. **Top Paper, Information Systems Division**
12. Turner, M. M., Cho, H. J., **Jeon, M.**, Jang, Y., Ye, Q., & Ha, J. H. (2024, November). Do nostalgia or regret appeals work on audiences outside of the target audience? [Extended abstract]. NCA 110th Annual Convention, New Orleans, LA.
11. **Jeon, M.**, Lim, S., Lapinski, M. K., Bente, G., & Schmälzle, R. (2024, June). Effects of cultural tailoring on visual attention: A virtual reality (VR) eye-tracking study using a billboard paradigm [Extended abstract]. ICA 74th Annual Conference, Gold Coast, Australia.

10. **Jeon, M.**, & Kim, Y. (2024, June). The role of fear, hope, message fatigue, and message shocking value in promoting the public's understanding and support toward COVID-19 wastewater monitoring. ICA 74th Annual Conference, Gold Coast, Australia.

9. Cho, H. J., Turner, M. M., **Jeon, M.**, Yoon, H., Long, J., & Ha, J. H. (2024, June). You can do it and here's how! The use (or absence) of efficacy messaging in obesity prevention campaigns. ICA 74th Annual Conference, Gold Coast, Australia.

8. Lim, S., Cho, H. J., **Jeon, M.**, & Schmälzle, R. (2024). Leveraging virtual reality (VR) with eye-tracking and generative artificial intelligence (AI) for message effects research [Poster]. Kentucky Conference on Health Communication (KCHC), Lexington, KY. **Top Six Honorable Mention**

7. **Jeon, M.**, & Liu, J. (2023). The influence of racial identity and bandwagon cues on tobacco health warning effectiveness in a social media context: An eye-tracking approach [Poster, remote]. Society for Research on Nicotine & Tobacco (SRNT) Annual Meeting, San Antonio, TX.

6. Turner, M. M., **Jeon, M.**, & Cho, H. J. (2023, November). What persuasive strategies are being used to tackle the U.S. obesity crisis? Obesity message interventions through the lens of narratives. NCA 109th Annual Convention, National Harbor, MD.

5. **Jeon, M.**, Kim, Y., Chung, S., & Bouslavskaya, T. (2023, November). Do body positive images improve our body perception? The role of social comparison on body perception and moods. NCA 109th Annual Convention, National Harbor, MD.

4. **Jeon, M.** (2023, September). Is perceived patient-provider communication quality (PPPCQ) distinguishable? Assessment of the affective and informative PPPCQ with the moderating role of race [Poster]. HINTS Data Users Conference, National Institutes of Health, Bethesda, MD.

3. **Jeon, M.**, & Liu, J. (2022, November). The role of identity and bandwagon cues in graphic health warning messages on social media: An eye-tracking approach. NCA 108th Annual Convention, New Orleans, LA.

2. Liu, J., Mi, R. Z., **Jeon, M.**, Fabbricatore, J., Wicke, R., Cojulun, L., & Yang, S. (2022, May). Evaluating the persuasive effect of construal level on information processing and counterargument in cannabis warning messages: An eye-tracking experiment. ICA 72nd Annual Conference, Paris, France.

1. Worsdale, A., Cojulun, L., & **Jeon, M.** (2022). College students' experiences using and seeking digital mental health services during COVID-19 [Poster]. Kentucky Conference on Health Communication (KCHC), Lexington, KY.

GRANT AND FUNDED PROJECT EXPERIENCE

Grant Co-Applicant

CSCA Federation Grant ($5,000); PI: Christopher (CJ) Calabrese Spring 2025

- Contributed to the proposal, deepfake literacy scale development, national survey on deepfake harm perceptions, and AI-chatbot intervention

Analysis and Writing on Funded Projects

National Cancer Institute, Serological Sciences Network (SeroNet); PI: Todd Lucas

- Joined after award; led data analysis and manuscript writing on culturally targeted COVID-19 antibody-testing messages in a randomized controlled trial

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Lapinski's Lion Research Team, Michigan State University Fall 2022 – Present

CASE (Cognition, Attitudes, and the Study of Emotion) Lab, Michigan State University Fall 2022 – Present

CHARM (Communication, Health, And emeRging Media) Lab, University of Georgia Spring 2021 – Spring 2022

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Instructor of Record (solo-taught), Michigan State University

COM 475 Public Communication Campaign Design and Analysis Spring 2026, Fall 2026

- In-person
- Upper-level strategic communication course redesigned around five skill-building workshops (template, annotated example, rubric)
- Students conduct formative audience research, design theory-driven campaigns, complete a one-on-one oral defense, and pitch proposals at a mock funders' conference

COM 275 Effects of Mass Communication (online) Summer 2025

COM 100 Introduction to Human Communication (online) Summer 2023

Instructor of Record (solo-taught), University of Georgia

COMM 1500 Introduction to Interpersonal Communication Summer 2021 – Spring 2022

Teaching Assistant / Recitation Instructor, Michigan State University

COM 300 Methods of Communication Inquiry (recitation) Spring 2025, Fall 2025

COM 275 Effects of Mass Communication Fall 2024

COM 240 Organizational Communication (recitation) Spring 2024

COM 100 Introduction to Human Communication (recitation) Fall 2022 – Fall 2023 (3 terms)

Teaching Assistant/ Recitation Instructor, University of Georgia

COMM 1500 Introduction to Interpersonal Communication (recitation) Fall 2020, Spring 2021

Guest Lecture, Michigan State University

COM 310 Interpersonal Communication Fall 2024

- Topic: Nonverbal communication and cultural space

EXPERIENTIAL LEARNING & STUDENT MENTORING

Undergraduate Research Mentor, Michigan State University Spring 2026
- Mentored undergraduate research assistants from codebook development and intercoder reliability training to presentations at MSU's undergraduate research forum

Student Lead, Graduate Research Team, Michigan State University Fall 2024 – Present
- Coordinated research projects and workflows for a graduate research team

Undergraduate Affairs Representative, Michigan State University Fall 2023 – Fall 2024

AWARDS, FELLOWSHIPS, & GRANTS

Graduate Office Fellowship Travel Award ($2,250), Michigan State University Fall 2026

Graduate Office Fellowship Travel Award ($3,500), Michigan State University Spring 2026

Graduate Office Fellowship Travel Award ($2,000), Michigan State University Fall 2025

CSCA Federation Grant ($5,000), Central States Communication Association Spring 2025

Kumata Fellowship ($2,000), Michigan State University Fall 2024

Graduate Office Fellowship Travel Award ($2,200), Michigan State University AY 2024–2025

Charles J. Strosacker Fellowship Award ($4,000), Michigan State University Spring 2024
- Competitive research award from the Charles J. Strosacker Graduate Research Fund for the Health and Risk Communication Center

Graduate Office Fellowship Travel Award ($1,667), Michigan State University Spring 2024

Graduate Office Fellowship ($2,900), Michigan State University Fall 2023

Rasmussen Doctoral Fellowship ($3,750), Michigan State University Spring 2023

Graduate Teaching Assistantship, Michigan State University Fall 2022 – Present

Graduate Student Research Seed Grant ($1,200), University of Georgia Fall 2021
- Departmental seed grant for graduate student-led research; funded master's thesis project

Graduate Teaching Assistantship, University of Georgia Fall 2020 – Spring 2022

Academic Excellence Scholarship, Sungkyunkwan University Spring 2017

CORE Scholarship Program, Sungkyunkwan University Aug. 2017 – Mar. 2018
- Initiative for College of Humanities' Research and Education (Korean Ministry of Education); full funding for exchange abroad study

SERVICE

Student Representative, Executive Subcommittee Summer 2025 – Summer 2027
Korean American Communication Association (ICA affiliate)

Treasurer Fall 2025 – Present
Association of Graduate Students in Communication (AGSC), Michigan State University

Undergraduate Affairs Representative Fall 2023 – Fall 2024
AGSC, Michigan State University

Chair Advisory Representative Fall 2023 – Fall 2024
AGSC, Michigan State University

Student Volunteer November 2023
National Communication Association Annual Convention

Treasurer Fall 2020 – Spring 2022
Korean Student Association, University of Georgia

REFERENCES

Dr. Maria K. Lapinski
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